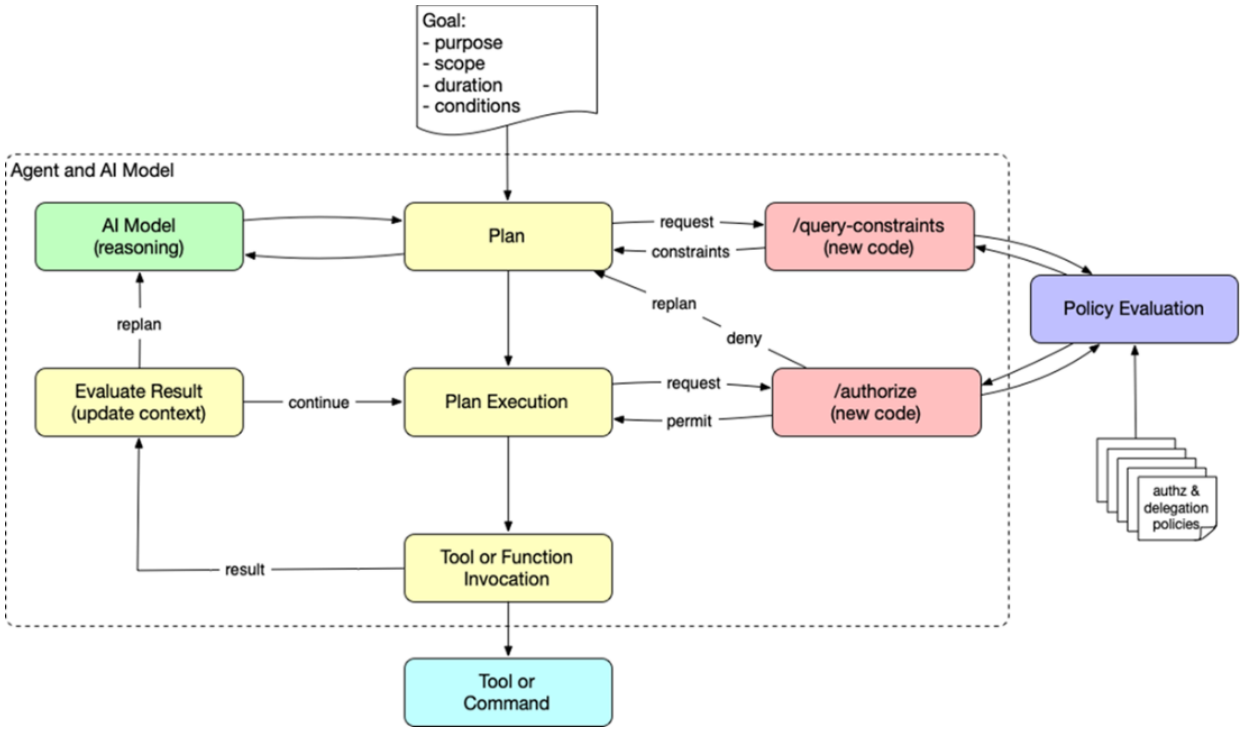


Figure 18.3 Policy constraints guiding agent planning. During planning, the agent queries the policy system with a partial request. The policy engine returns constraints—such as permitted actions or accessible resources—that the agent incorporates into its plan. Each action is still evaluated at execution time to ensure consistent enforcement.

Instead of proposing actions blindly, the agent now directly incorporates policy-derived constraints into its reasoning. During planning, it can submit a partial authorization request—for example, specifying the principal, resource, and context while leaving the action unspecified.

Rather than simply returning permit or deny decisions, the policy engine produces a structured result that specifies which actions satisfy the policy conditions. Conceptually, the response might look like this:

```
principal: Agent::"acme_assist"
resource: CustomerDocument::"custco-briefing"
permitted_actions:
  - documents.search
  - documents.read
  - documents.summarize
```

The agent can then construct a plan using only actions that are likely to succeed.